

black eyebrows so mobile from excitement they seemed likely, any moment, to scamper up his forehead and vanish into his hair. He was Julian Street, the young author, and he was clutching in a trousers' pocket something unprecedented in the pockets of all other authors I had ever known. Street had fifty yellow \$1,000 bills. He explained possession credibly; the money was part of his wife's inheritance and, after an adventure, he had just retrieved it from one of the trust companies.

On that first morning of the panic Street had taken fright as had every one else; you could catch the infection of terror over the telephone from the tone of a voice. A short while before a considerable part of his wife's fortune had been turned into cash. Pending reinvestment, it was on deposit with one of the trust companies; but even the strongest trust companies had become suspect. As he came down-town everywhere Street saw men and women dashing about in the manner of ants when their hill is trod on. He determined to get the money and bring it to me.

When he presented his certificate of deposit at the trust company he was invited into a conference with a vice-president. This man attempted to reason with Street; he said the company was as strong as the country itself and that it was foolish for Mr. Street to incur the risk of robbery or loss by some other means. But Street was firm, and so another official added his arguments and when he could not change the client's mind, the president himself joined the group. For nearly three hours those men argued and cajoled. Probably their pride was involved, but all that they said simply frightened Street more, until he was the personification of the 1907 panic.

"The country is in terrible shape," he said, "if you three men can spend hours making such a to-do about an account of this size."

"But for your own good, Mr. Street . . ."

"Cash!" roared Street. "I want the cash. Read what it says on this certificate: payment on demand. I demand the cash."